

MATTHEW BEARDWELL

Watford, Hertfordshire · mbeardwell.com · contact@mbeardwell.com

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · [TryHackMe](#)

Professional Summary

SOC Analyst Trainee with hands-on cybersecurity experience and a First-Class BSc (Hons) in Computer Science. Skilled in HUMINT-style OSINT investigative techniques, now applying this toward infosec workflows. Ranked in the top 2% globally on TryHackMe (114 completed rooms, 16 badges). Currently preparing for CompTIA Security+ to strengthen expertise in SIEM, SOC operations, and incident response.

Technical Skills

- **Security and Threat Detection:** SIEM (Splunk), Sysmon, Windows Logs, OSINT
- **Scripting and Programming:** Python, Bash, PowerShell, C, ARM ASM
- **Systems Admin:** Group Policy, Linux Hardening, Virtualisation
- **Incident Response:** Wireshark, TCP/IP, Firewalls

Cybersecurity Projects

'ActiveReconLite': A Python Port Scanner

Feb 2025 – Mar 2025

Built a Python-based TCP connect port scanner using multiprocessing. Scanned 65k ports in 5s (vs Nmap's 5m). It validates user input, grabs banners, and writes results to a file. Demonstrates automation, socket programming, and parallel scanning.

github.com/mbeardwell/active-recon-lite

Technologies: Python, Multiprocessing, Network Scanning

'Faster Dynamically Instrumented Programs' · Bachelor's Thesis

Oct 2022 – May 2023

Designed and implemented a dynamic code modification technique that intercepts processor instructions at runtime, demonstrating low-level reverse engineering and malware analysis applications.

github.com/mbeardwell/arm-fp-emu

Technologies: C, ARM Assembly, Dynamic Binary Instrumentation

Professional Experience

Building expertise during ongoing health recovery. Not currently available for roles. Open to future opportunities.

SOC Training and Labs · TryHackMe (Self-Led Learning)

Feb 2022 – Present

Developed hands-on expertise in SIEM, threat hunting, and security automation through 114 cybersecurity labs (Top 2% globally). Applied log analysis, detection logic, and SOC tooling in simulation labs.

Retail Assistant · Max Spielmann (Prince's Trust Work Placement)

Feb 2024 – Mar 2024

Processed transactions, assisted customers with self-service kiosks and mobile integration, and ensured secure deletion of processed passport photos.

Private Tutor · Freelance

Sep 2016 – Nov 2019

Supported children with pre-GCSE homework, primarily in maths; adapted explanations to varying ability levels in informal settings.

Research and Documentation Intern · Indo UK Institute of Health

Jun 2017 – Aug 2017

Conducted market research on employee benefits and strategic partnerships, providing executives with key insights. Edited and reformatted high-level strategic documents that shaped discussions on a billion-pound healthcare initiative.

Education and Certifications

BSc Computer Science King's College London (1st Class Honours)

Sep 2018 – Jun 2023

A-Levels King's College London Mathematics School (4 A*s)

Sep 2016 – Jun 2018

GCSE and IGCSEs 9 A*s, 1 B (incl. A* in Computing, Maths, Sciences)

Sep 2014 – Jun 2016

Certifications

CompTIA Security+

(In Progress)

TryHackMe: Introduction to Cyber Security

Feb 2024

TryHackMe: Pre Security

Apr 2022

Security Blue Team: Introduction to OSINT

Jun 2025

Prince's Trust Level 2 (12-week employability program)

Jan 2024 – Apr 2024